SMM
Shanghai Metals Market

SMM IRON ORE DAILY

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-10-26 Monday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply-Demand · Inventory · Commentary

Source **SMM / SGX**

Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

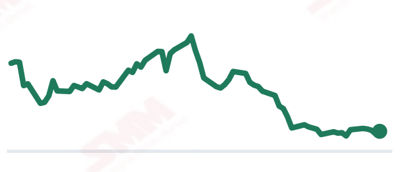
SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract Latest price

90.70

USD/dmt

FEFV26 · 2026-10 · SGX

As of preparation: 2026-10-26 18:08:56 (UTC+8)
Quote time: 10-26 17:54:57 (UTC+8)



Last 3 months

DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701 Daily

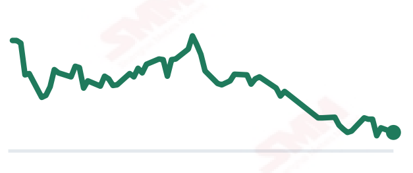
671.5

yuan/mt

▼ -3.5 -0.52%

MTD avg **677.2**

As of Oct 26 · vs Oct 23



Last 3 months

SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Oct 26

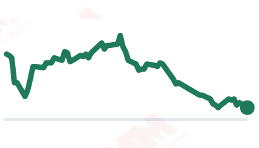
MMi 61% Port Spot Daily

654

yuan/wmt

▼ -4 -0.61%

MTD avg **659**



Last 3 months

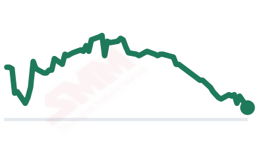
MMi 58% Port Spot Daily

608

yuan/wmt

▼ -8 -1.30%

MTD avg **617**



Last 3 months

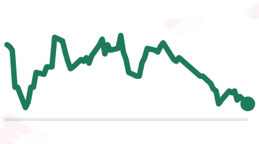
MMi 65% Port Spot Daily

813

yuan/wmt

▼ -4 -0.49%

MTD avg **819**



Last 3 months

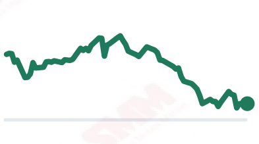
MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily

89.20

USD/dmt

— 0.00 0.00%

MTD avg **90.31**



Last 3 months

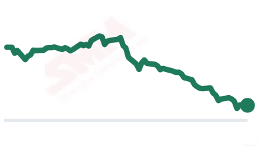
MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily

106.75

USD/dmt

▼ -0.05 -0.05%

MTD avg **108.72**



Last 3 months

SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily

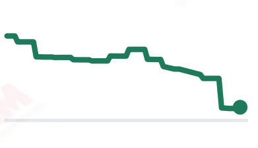
797.36

yuan/mt

▲ +1.03 +0.13%

MTD avg **809.35**

As of Oct 23 · vs Oct 22



Last 3 months

Key View

Port prices soften while seaborne quotations hold; buying remains key as arrivals recover

Domestic futures and port prices weakened while seaborne quotations were relatively stable. DCE most-traded closed at 671.5 yuan/mt, down 0.52%; the 61%, 58% and 65% port indices fell to 654, 608 and 813 yuan/wmt. The seaborne 61% index held at USD 89.20/dmt, the 65% eased to 106.75, and all 12 brand quotations were unchanged from the previous report. Divergent performance indicates that price support still differs across markets.

Supply flows are recovering. In the week to Oct 23, arrivals in China rose 12.47% WoW and global shipments increased 2.83%. Higher arrivals may add to available spot material, but inventory changes also depend on unloading and mill collections. The latest modest increase in hot metal supports baseline consumption without necessarily implying discretionary restocking.

Sustained transactions remain the key test of near-term direction. Needs-based buying could leave higher arrivals and existing stocks constraining upside; improved orders and margins followed by stronger collections would support the market. Supply flows, port trading and mill profitability should be assessed together rather than treating a single day of flat seaborne quotations as a broad trend improvement.

Today's Highlights

- **Domestic futures and port prices weakened.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **671.5 yuan/mt**, down 3.5 yuan (-0.52%) from Oct 23. Qingdao PB and Newman Fines were both 640 yuan/wmt and Mac Fines were 646, each down 3 yuan; BRBF was 690 (-6), Newman Lump 820 (-13) and PB Lump 815 (-8).
- **Seaborne indices changed little and brand quotations held steady.** The 61% index was unchanged at **USD 89.20/dmt**; the 65% was **106.75**, down 0.05 (-0.05%). All 12 brands were unchanged from the Oct 23 report, with PB Fines at 89.55, Newman Fines 88.65 and Mac Fines 88.95 USD/dmt.
- **The low-grade port index fell more sharply.** The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 654, 608 and 813 yuan/wmt, down 4, 8 and 4 yuan. The 65%-58% spread widened from 201 to 205 yuan/wmt.
- **Latest arrivals and shipments recovered.** Arrivals in China were **27.6076 million mt** in the week to Oct 23, up 3.0612 million mt (+12.47%) WoW; global shipments rose 921,800 mt (+2.83%) to 33.4494 million mt. The impact of higher flows still depends on mill collection schedules.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	10-26 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	640	▼ -3 -0.47%	645	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	640	▼ -3 -0.47%	647	*
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	646	▼ -3 -0.46%	650	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	690	▼ -6 -0.86%	697	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	820	▼ -13 -1.56%	837	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	502	▼ -3 -0.59%	507	
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	815	▼ -3 -0.37%	824	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	815	▼ -8 -0.97%	831	*

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	10-26 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	10-23
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	86.10	— 0.00 0.00%	86.10
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	87.80	— 0.00 0.00%	87.80
PB Fines 62% Daily	89.55	— 0.00 0.00%	89.55
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	88.65	— 0.00 0.00%	88.65
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	88.95	— 0.00 0.00%	88.95
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	86.45	— 0.00 0.00%	86.45
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	105.50	— 0.00 0.00%	105.50
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	96.50	— 0.00 0.00%	96.50
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	96.05	— 0.00 0.00%	96.05
RTX Fines 61% Daily	85.30	— 0.00 0.00%	85.30
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	89.20	— 0.00 0.00%	89.20
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	79.30	— 0.00 0.00%	79.30

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	90.31	-6.42%	-15.8%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	108.72	-4.99%	-12.0%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	659	-4.85%	-19.6%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	819	-2.40%	-9.6%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	617	-4.63%	-15.3%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	809.35	-3.48%	-10.1%	yuan/mt	

The seaborne 61% index held at USD 89.20/dmt, while the 65% was 106.75 (-0.05%), narrowing their spread from USD 17.60 to 17.55/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 654, 608 and 813 yuan/wmt, down 4, 8 and 4 yuan.

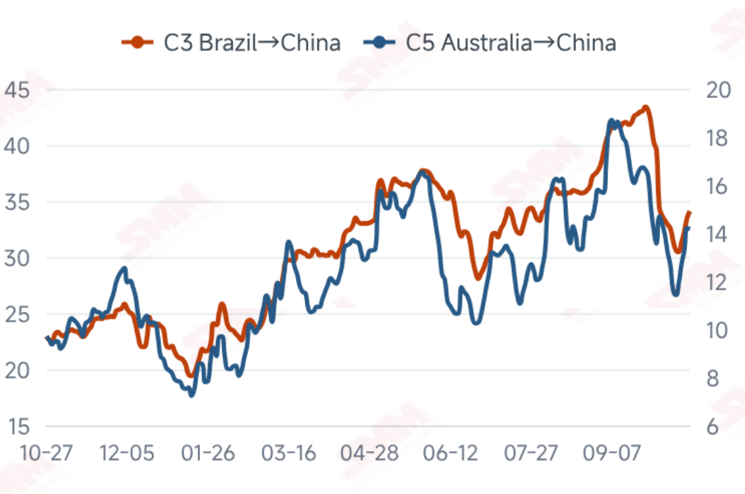
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

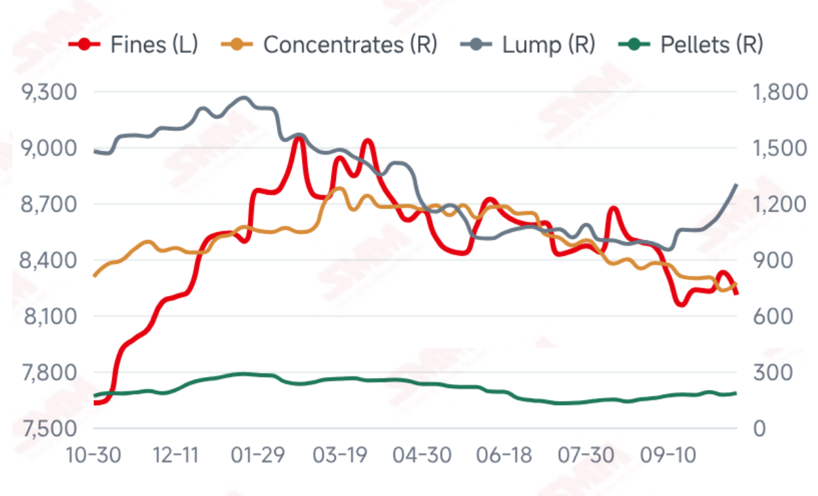
Iron Ore Ocean Freight

USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



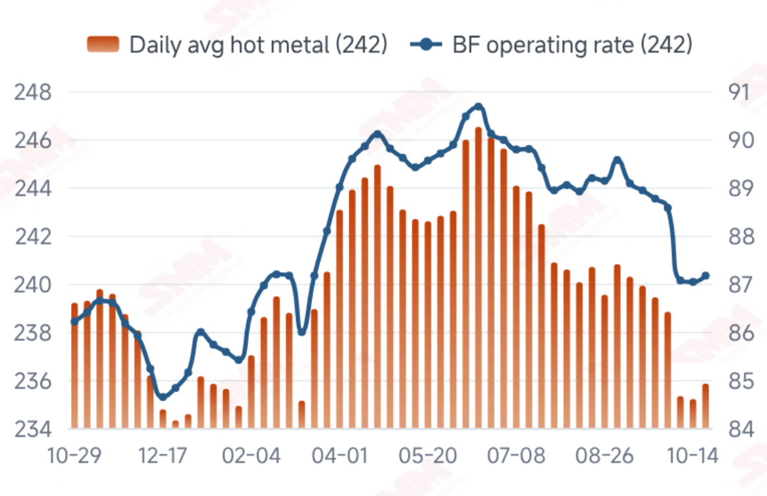
Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product

Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



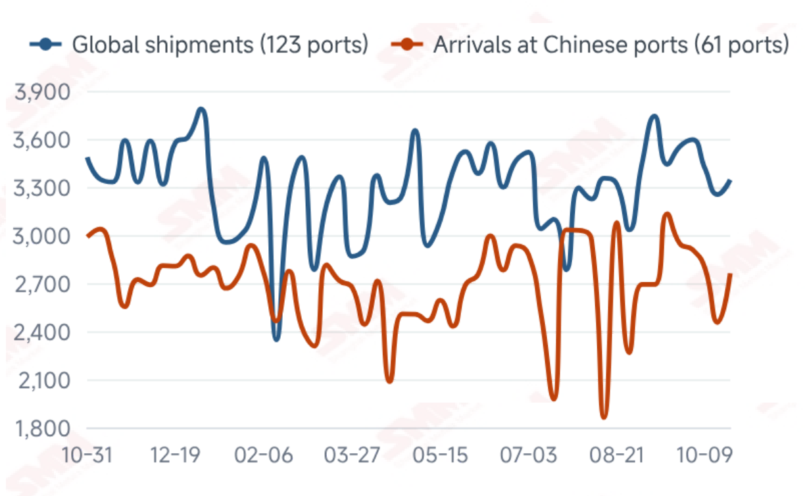
Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills

Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports

10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports



Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 671.5 yuan/mt, down 0.52% from Oct 23. Qingdao PB Fines were 640, Newman Fines 640, Mac Fines 646, SSF 502 and Carajas Fines 815 yuan/wmt, each down 3 yuan. BRBF fell 6 yuan to 690, Newman Lump fell 13 yuan to 820 and PB Lump fell 8 yuan to 815. SGX official current-month FEFV26 was last priced at USD 90.70/dmt, timestamped Oct 26, 17:54:57 (UTC+8). SMM's daily review described needs-based mill purchases and limited spot transactions.

Drivers Domestic futures and port quotations fell while the seaborne 61% index and brand quotations were broadly steady, showing short-term differences across markets. The larger decline in the low-grade port index may influence blending economics, but a spread change alone does not establish a sustained shift in demand structure. Price support still needs confirmation from transactions and mill buying.

Demand The latest SMM survey of 242 mills showed daily hot metal output of 2.3584 million mt on Oct 21, up 6,400 mt from Oct 14, with a blast furnace operating rate of 87.16%. Improved production may support baseline consumption, but restocking also depends on mill stocks, finished-steel orders and margins. If purchases mainly cover immediate needs, the modest output increase may offer limited support for ore prices.

Inventory & supply Global shipments were 33.4494 million mt in the week to Oct 23, up 2.83% WoW. Australia shipped 19.7148 million mt (+5.77%) and Brazil 8.2370 million mt (+3.50%). Arrivals in China rose 12.47% to 27.6076 million mt. The latest ten-port stocks were 104.6534 million mt on Oct 22, up 632,200 mt from Oct 15. Higher arrivals may increase available material, but further inventory pressure also depends on unloading and mill collections.

Cost & margin Oct 23 freight was USD 34.09/mt for C3, up 1.76% from the previous reading, and 14.16 for C5, down 0.28%. Route-specific costs differed, while actual landed costs also depend on quotations, contracts and exchange rates. Lower port selling prices may squeeze returns on some trades, but price direction alone cannot establish a margin; import trading and steelmaking profitability should be assessed separately. SMM's assessment published on the morning of Oct 26 put the period's average import margin at 4.57 yuan/mt, up 3.54 yuan from 1.03; this does not represent mill profitability after the current session's close.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices The latest Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 797.36 yuan/mt on Oct 23, up 0.13% from the previous reading. SMM's Oct 26 Shandong brief quoted 64% basic concentrate at 757 yuan/mt, up 2 yuan, on a dry-basis, pre-tax ex-works basis. This regional quotation is not directly comparable with the national index.

Supply & demand SMM reported mostly normal mine operations in Shandong, virtually no stocks at miners and nearby traders, and scheduled shipments at smaller plants and traders. Local resources and contract execution may support prices, but mill purchasing still depends on margins and orders; the regional description does not represent national inventory conditions.

Outlook SMM expects Shandong concentrate prices to remain relatively stable near term. Tight regional supply and sustained collections could support offers, while continued mill cost control and cautious buying may limit upside.

Market Factors

▲ Supportive factors

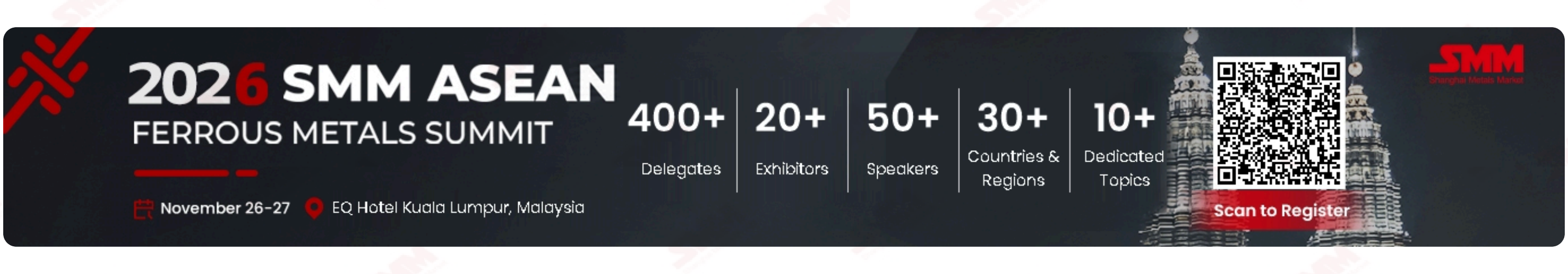
- The seaborne 61% index and all 12 brand quotations held steady.
- Latest surveyed daily hot metal output increased 6,400 mt WoW.
- Resource constraints in some domestic regions may support offers.
- C5 freight edged lower, cushioning some transport costs.

▼ Bearish factors

- DCE fell 0.52% and all eight port quotations declined.
- The port 58% index fell 1.30%, keeping composite prices under pressure.
- Arrivals in China rose 12.47% WoW as supply flows recovered.
- Sustained purchasing improvement still depends on orders and profitability.

Flash News

- [SMM Iron Ore] Arrivals rebound 12.5%, ending port draw; iron ore seen softer ↗
  2026-10-26
- [Domestic Iron Ore Brief] Iron ore concentrate prices in the Shandong region are likely to remain relatively stable ↗
  2026-10-26
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Brief] 20261026 ↗
  2026-10-26
- [SMM Iron Ore] Imported iron ore margin widens to 4.57 yuan/mt on firmer spot prices ↗
  2026-10-26
- [SMM Steel] Vietnam HRC Import Trading Improves as Indonesian Cargoes Attract Buyers ↗
  2026-10-26
- [SMM Steel] India Steel and Scrap Prices edge down Amid Slow Buying ↗
  2026-10-26



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